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Welfare Trade-Offs and Post-Transgression Responses 6 (#163092)

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1) Have any data been collected for this study already?
No, no data have been collected for this study yet.

2) What's the main question being asked or hypothesis being tested in this study?
The main purpose of this study is to examine the effect that victims' post-transgression responses (PTRs) to seek revenge or forgive and ability for future actions to be monitored (yes, no) affects transgressors' welfare trade-offs (e.g., vigilance to not transgress again, worry, rumination, self-control, nonapology, apology, and egalitarian behaviour). It will also test the moderating role of relationship value and power. Finally, this study will test the mediating role of cost-benefit analysis. Overall, we predict that the effect of victims' PTRs on transgressors' welfare trade-offs will be differentially affected by the victims' ability to monitor the future actions of the transgressor (or not), and that relationship value and will moderate, and cost-benefits will mediate, the relation. Based on Tooby et al.'s (2008) theorizing about welfare trade-offs and McCullough et al.'s (2013) theorizing about revenge and forgiveness systems, we predict mediated moderation among our key variables. More specifically, we predict that transgressors will be more vigilant about not committing future transgressions when victims seek revenge and can monitor transgressors' future actions. In comparison, we predict that transgressors will be more vigilant about not committing future transgressions when victims forgive and cannot monitor transgressors' future actions. Based on our design, we predict a PTR (revenge, forgiveness) by monitor (yes, no) by relationship value, 2 x 2 x relationship value, between-groups interaction on transgressors' welfare trade-offs (WTOs) toward the victim.

3) Describe the key dependent variable(s) specifying how they will be measured.
Transgressors' WTOs toward victims are operationalized as transgressors' cognitive, affective, and behavioural vigilance reflected in transgressors' worry, rumination, self-control over not committing future transgressions, nonapology, apology, and assignment of ballots for a cash draw. We use the 8-item Worry Domains Questionnaire-Short Form (Stober & Joorman, 2001 (e.g., I would worry that I would lose the other person's respect)), the 6-item Rumination about an Interpersonal Offence Scale (Wade, et al., 2008 (e.g., I wouldn't be able to stop thinking about how I affected the person I hurt), the 13-item Brief Self-Control Scale (Tagney et al., 2004 (e.g., I would say inappropriate things to the other person)), Guilfoyle's (2018) 12-item nonapology/9-item apology scale (e.g., I want to assure the person that I hurt that I won't do this again), the 5-item Cost and Benefits of Relationships Survey (Dardis et al., 2013 (e.g., How committed would the person who you hurt be to their relationship with you in the future)), the 4-item Scale of Value in Usefulness modified from Ohtsubo & Yagi, 2015 (e.g., Please indicate how useful the other person was in helping you achieve the following goals: academic goals; social goals; career goals; other goals), and the 5-item Scale of Value in Feelings (Walker & Thompson, 1983 (e.g. We enjoy the relationship)). Also, we use the 1-item Scale of Identity Closeness (Aron et al., 1992) to measure transgressors' closeness to the victim. We developed our own 8-item cost-benefit variable (e.g., The person's response whom I hurt would be beneficial to me by helping me to not hurt them again.).

4) How many and which conditions will participants be assigned to?
This study uses a 2x2 experimental between groups design. The key independent variables are victims' PTRs (revenge, forgiveness), ability to monitor transgressors' future actions (yes, no), and relationship value (measured with a continuous measure). Participants will be randomly assigned to one of the 4 conditions that emerge from the 2x2 design.

5) Specify exactly which analyses you will conduct to examine the main question/hypothesis.
To test our primary prediction of a 2-way interaction, we will conduct 2x2 between-group ANOVAs on our dependent variables as well as Hayes' (2012) PROCESS analysis to test for mediated moderation. Simple effects will be tested to probe significant interaction effects.

6) Describe exactly how outliers will be defined and handled, and your precise rule(s) for excluding observations.
The exclusion criteria for the sample will be: (1) incomplete responding, (2) random responders as determined by the Conscientious Responders Scale (Marjanovic et al., 2012), and (3) outliers.

7) How many observations will be collected or what will determine sample size? No need to justify decision, but be precise about exactly how the number will be determined.
Participants will be recruited using our psychology department's undergraduate research participant pool. Based on a priori power analyses to detect a small to moderate interaction effect size, f = .15 (based on typical effect sizes found in our previous research), to determine 90% power, $\alpha = .05$, N = 469. Given potential participant exclusions, we hope to recruit approximately 600 participants.

8) Anything else you would like to pre-register? (e.g., secondary analyses, variables collected for exploratory purposes, unusual analyses planned?)
We will include measures of other potential and exploratory moderators and mediators, e.g., power.